

D376

Product, Price, and Customer Experience

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A kitchenware company collected 40 raw product ideas through an employee contest; the winner received a \$500 gift card. The team has just dropped every idea that does not fit its brand or factory capabilities. The CEO prefers a minimalist design style. Which step comes next?

- A. Run a test market in two cities.
- B. Launch the best idea nationally.
- C. Generate more ideas through another contest.
- D. Develop the surviving ideas into concepts and test them with target customers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2.

Sales of a home-fitness bike brand have leveled off after years of fast growth. Many rivals now sell similar bikes, and profits are under pressure. The brand's founder recently appeared on a popular podcast. Which strategy best fits this stage?

- A. Differentiate with new features or services and defend market share.
- B. Cut all marketing now, since sales will only fall from here.
- C. Build the strategy around booking the founder on more podcasts.
- D. Spend heavily to explain what a home-fitness bike is to first-time buyers.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A product's marketer is running heavy informative ads, sells through a few selected outlets, and is losing money on the product. Which life-cycle stage is it most likely in?

- A. Introduction
- B. Maturity
- C. Decline, because the product is losing money.
- D. Growth

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4.

A meal-kit startup based in a converted warehouse competes with grocery stores and other kits. Its research shows busy parents most want a healthy dinner on the table in 20 minutes. The CFO is proud of the warehouse's new solar roof. Which is the strongest value proposition?

- A. Packed in a solar-powered warehouse.
- B. Healthy family dinners on the table in 20 minutes, with no planning and no shopping.
- C. Each kit includes 14 ingredients, a recipe card, and insulated packaging.
- D. The best meal kit in the world, guaranteed.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A boutique buys a handbag for \$60 from a family-run supplier in Italy and sells it for \$100. The owner wants the gross margin as a percentage of the selling price. What is it?

- A. 66.7%
- B. 60%
- C. 40%
- D. \$40

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A retailer wants a 25% gross margin on the selling price of an item that costs \$150. What price must it charge?

- A. \$187.50
- B. \$600
- C. \$112.50
- D. \$200

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A tech firm is launching a patented noise-canceling headset. Enthusiasts are eager to pay a premium, and rivals cannot copy the technology for about two years. The launch event will be held in Austin. Which pricing strategy fits best?

- A. Price skimming
- B. Penetration pricing
- C. Cost-plus pricing with a standard markup, ignoring demand
- D. Always match the cheapest competitor's price

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A company sets a low launch price to win market share quickly in a price-sensitive market where higher volume cuts its unit costs. Which strategy is this?

- A. Price skimming
- B. Prestige pricing
- C. Predatory pricing
- D. Penetration pricing

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A clinic surveyed 200 patients using a new tablet app at the front desk. 110 gave a score of 9–10, 50 gave 7–8, and 40 gave 0–6. What is the Net Promoter Score?

- A. 55
- B. 70
- C. 35
- D. 60

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A hotel's NPS is +20, and 50% of respondents are promoters. What percentage are detractors?

- A. 70%
- B. 50%
- C. 30%
- D. 20%

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A bank’s product committee wants to redesign its mobile app. Several senior leaders, each with more than 20 years at the bank, have strong opinions. The current app was built by an outside vendor. Which is a voice-of-the-customer method?

- A.** Ask the vendor which features are easiest to build.
- B.** Analyze app-store reviews and interview customers about where they get stuck.
- C.** Copy the top competitor’s app, since customers always want what rivals offer.
- D.** Survey the senior leadership team about the features they prefer.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

An online furniture seller has fast checkout and strong prices, but many customers post angry reviews about missed delivery windows and hard-to-reach support after they buy. The company recently redesigned its logo. Where should experience management focus first?

- A.** Lower prices so customers forgive delivery problems.
- B.** The post-purchase delivery and support touchpoints on the customer journey map.
- C.** Test another version of the new logo.
- D.** Speed up checkout even further.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A kitchenware company collected 40 raw product ideas through an employee contest; ~~the winner received a \$500 gift card.~~ The team has just dropped every idea that does not fit its brand or factory capabilities. ~~The CEO prefers a minimalist design style.~~ Which step comes next?

Target word: next NPD stage **Decides:** Dropping poor-fit ideas is screening; concept testing follows.

A	Adjacent category	Test marketing comes only after a product has been developed.
B	Dropped element	Skips concept testing, business analysis, development, and test marketing.
C	Inverted operation	Moves backward to the stage already completed.
D	Correct	Concept development and testing follows idea screening.

2. Answer A Concept 2

Sales of a home-fitness bike brand have leveled off after years of fast growth. Many rivals now sell similar bikes, and profits are under pressure. ~~The brand's founder recently appeared on a popular podcast.~~ Which strategy best fits this stage?

Target word: strategy for the life-cycle stage **Decides:** Flat sales and many similar rivals signal maturity.

A	Correct	Maturity strategy: modify product and market to hold share against many competitors.
B	Absolute language	That is a decline-stage harvest move, and "only fall" overstates it.
C	Camouflage	Answers the podcast detail, which does not decide the stage.
D	Adjacent category	Category education fits the introduction stage.

3. Answer A Concept 2 · transfer

A product's marketer is running heavy informative ads, sells through a few selected outlets, and is losing money on the product. Which life-cycle stage is it most likely in?

Target word: reverse: from tactics to stage **Decides:** Informative ads plus limited distribution plus losses point to introduction.

A	Correct	New products need awareness, have thin distribution, and usually lose money at first.
B	Confusion set	Mature products have broad distribution and use persuasive, not informative, ads.
C	Dropped element	Uses only the loss and ignores the informative ads and limited outlets.
D	Confusion set	Growth brings rising profits and widening distribution.

4. Answer B Concept 3

A meal-kit startup ~~based in a converted warehouse~~ competes with grocery stores and other kits. Its research shows busy parents most want a healthy dinner on the table in 20 minutes. ~~The CFO is proud of the warehouse's new solar roof.~~ Which is the strongest value proposition?

Target word: strongest value proposition **Decides:** Research names the benefit busy parents value most.

A	Camouflage	Answers the solar-roof detail, not what busy parents want.
B	Correct	States the specific benefit the target customer values, versus the alternatives.
C	Adjacent category	Features, not the benefit the customer gets.
D	Absolute language	An unprovable superlative with no customer benefit.

5. Answer C Concept 4

A boutique buys a handbag for \$60 from a family-run supplier in Italy and sells it for \$100. The owner wants the gross margin as a percentage of the selling price. What is it?

Target word: margin % on price **Decides:** Divide the \$40 profit by the \$100 price.

A	Confusion set	That is markup on cost: $\$40 / \60 .
B	Inverted operation	Cost / price; the share of price that is cost, not margin.
C	Correct	$(\$100 - \$60) / \$100 = 40\%$.
D	Dropped element	The dollar margin; the question asks for a percentage.

6. Answer D Concept 4 • transfer

A retailer wants a 25% gross margin on the selling price of an item that costs \$150. What price must it charge?

Target word: solve for price **Decides:** Price = cost / (1 – margin) = $\$150 / 0.75$.

A	Confusion set	Adds a 25% markup on cost; margin on that price is only 20%.
B	Dropped element	$\$150 / 0.25$ drops the “1 –” in the formula.
C	Inverted operation	Subtracts 25% from cost; the price would be below cost.
D	Correct	$\$150 / 0.75 = \200 ; check: $\$50 / \$200 = 25\%$.

7. Answer A Concept 5

A tech firm is launching a patented noise-canceling headset. Enthusiasts are eager to pay a premium, and rivals cannot copy the technology for about two years. ~~The launch event will be held in Austin.~~ Which pricing strategy fits best?

Target word: launch pricing strategy **Decides:** Premium demand plus protection from copying.

A	Correct	High initial price captures eager buyers while patents block competitors.
B	Confusion set	Low launch pricing suits price-sensitive markets and easy copying.
C	Adjacent category	Leaves money on the table when buyers will pay a premium.
D	Absolute language	There is no direct competitor yet, and “always” ignores the premium demand.

8. Answer D Concept 5 • transfer

A company sets a low launch price to win market share quickly in a price-sensitive market where higher volume cuts its unit costs. Which strategy is this?

Target word: reverse: from description to strategy **Decides:** Low price to build share and scale.

A	Inverted operation	Skimming starts high, not low.
B	Confusion set	Prestige pricing keeps prices high to signal quality.
C	Adjacent category	Predatory pricing means pricing below cost to drive rivals out, often illegal; this is ordinary share-building.
D	Correct	Low entry price to gain share, using economies of scale.

9. Answer C Concept 6

A clinic surveyed 200 patients ~~using a new tablet app at the front desk~~. 110 gave a score of 9-10, 50 gave 7-8, and 40 gave 0-6. What is the Net Promoter Score?

Target word: NPS **Decides:** 55% promoters – 20% detractors.

A	Dropped element	The promoter share alone; ignores detractors.
B	Wrong stem number	Subtracts raw counts (110 – 40) instead of percentages.
C	Correct	$110/200 = 55\%$; $40/200 = 20\%$; $55 - 20 = 35$.
D	Adjacent category	Counts passives as promoters: $80\% - 20\%$.

10. Answer C Concept 6 · transfer

A hotel's NPS is +20, and 50% of respondents are promoters. What percentage are detractors?

Target word: solve for detractor share **Decides:** Detractors = promoters – NPS = $50 - 20$.

A	Inverted operation	Adds NPS to promoters instead of subtracting.
B	Dropped element	Assumes everyone not a promoter is a detractor; drops the passives.
C	Correct	$50\% - 30\% = +20$; the remaining 20% are passives.
D	Wrong stem number	The NPS value, not the detractor share.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A bank's product committee wants to redesign its mobile app. Several senior leaders, ~~each with more than 20 years at the bank~~, have strong opinions. ~~The current app was built by an outside vendor~~. Which is a voice-of-the-customer method?

Target word: a true VOC method **Decides:** VOC comes from customers themselves.

A	Camouflage	Answers the vendor detail; feasibility is not customer voice.
B	Correct	Direct customer words and behavior are the voice of the customer.
C	Absolute language	Assumes customer needs without asking them.
D	Adjacent category	Internal opinion, not customer input.

12. Answer B Concept 8

An online furniture seller has fast checkout and strong prices, but many customers post angry reviews about missed delivery windows and hard-to-reach support after they buy. ~~The company recently redesigned its logo~~. Where should experience management focus first?

Target word: priority stage of the journey **Decides:** Pain points cluster after purchase.

A	Dropped element	Treats experience as price only and leaves the broken touchpoints in place.
B	Correct	Fix the stage where complaints cluster.
C	Camouflage	The logo does not cause delivery or support failures.
D	Adjacent category	Checkout already works; it is not where the pain is.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	7	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	2	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	8	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	5	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	4	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	4	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	New product development sequence	Ideas move through generation, screening, concept testing, business analysis, product development, test marketing, and commercialization, in that order.	Jumping from a promising idea straight to building or launching.	“What comes next?” after a named NPD step.
2	Product life cycle strategy	Introduction builds awareness; growth expands reach; maturity differentiates and defends share; decline harvests, cuts, or repositions.	Using introduction or growth tactics when sales have leveled off.	Sales trend plus number of competitors plus profit pressure.
3	Value proposition	A value proposition states the benefit a specific customer gets, and why it beats the alternatives, not a list of features.	Listing features or making unprovable superlatives.	“Why should the customer choose us?”
4	Markup vs. margin	Margin % = (price – cost) / price; markup % = (price – cost) / cost.	Dividing by cost when margin on selling price is asked, or the reverse.	“As a percentage of selling price” vs. “on cost.”
5	Skimming vs. penetration pricing	Skimming launches high to capture buyers willing to pay a premium when rivals cannot copy quickly; penetration launches low to win share fast in price-sensitive markets.	Swapping the two, or choosing penetration for a protected, premium innovation.	Barriers to copying and customer price sensitivity at launch.
6	Net Promoter Score	NPS = % promoters (9–10) – % detractors (0–6); passives (7–8) count only in the total.	Counting passives as promoters or subtracting raw counts.	Survey scores grouped 0–6, 7–8, 9–10.
7	Voice of the customer	VOC collects what customers themselves say and do (interviews, reviews, surveys, behavior) to guide decisions.	Treating executive or vendor opinion as customer input.	“Which method captures the customer’s view?”
8	Journey-wide experience management	Customer experience is managed across every touchpoint of the journey; fix the stages where pain points cluster.	Polishing a touchpoint that already works while the real pain is elsewhere.	Complaints concentrated at one stage of the journey.

Course scope (public description): Product, Price, & Customer Experience teaches core marketing concepts used to create integrative marketing strategies that meet the needs of an organization and its customers. This course teaches topics of new product development, product management, value proposition, and customer experience management. The voice of the customer is taught to ensure marketers create a customer-centric culture within their organization to meet the needs, wants, and preference of their target market. Customer experience management practices are key focal points of this course to ensure meaningful customer interactions across the entire customer journey.